> Polish innocence. . . . Although the defensive camp had different faces, what united them was the building of fortifications to entrench themselves in the position of an innocent victim. . . . The debate over *Neighbors* revealed, however, not only divisions related to the national past but also the vitality of a particular mentality, dating back to the 1930s or even to the end of the 19th century. A litmus test of this mentality was the language used during the debate by some of its participants. It was this language that loudly echoed the legacy of National Democracy with all its reservoir of anti-Semitic clichés and stereotypes.[12]

By then, of course, the genie had been let out of the bottle and the result was increasing social polarization and an increasingly angry debate. The publication in 2006 and 2011, respectively, of two successive books by Gross, *Fear* and *Golden Harvest*, precipitated additional discussion and controversy. These books graphically chronicle acts of violence perpetrated against Jews and detail the widespread postwar plunder of Jewish property. *Golden Harvest* contains a stark portrayal of how local peasants ravaged the incinerated remains of Jews murdered in Treblinka, in search of gold. As a result, Gross has become one of the most hated people in Poland. Janusz Kurtyka, who succeeded the courageous Leon Keres as head of the increasingly nationalistically inclined Institute for National Remembrance (IPN)—the state-sponsored body charged with investigating crimes by both the Nazis and the Communists, the Germans and the Soviets—went so far as to call Gross "a vampire of historiography."[13]

The chilling account by a Polish eyewitness of the robbery, torture, and rape of eighteen Jews by local people in Gniewczyna Tryniecka in May 1942 was also the subject of much discussion. The witness to this outrage, 12 years old at the time, had remained silent. However, shortly before his death in 2010, Tadeusz Markiel said that he could no longer keep the excruciating secret to himself.[14] The subsequent publication of scholarly books by historians such as Jan Grabowski and Barbara Engelking reveal an unvarnished picture of the betrayal, suffering, and death of Jews at the hands of "ordinary" Poles on the local level.[15]

The release of the 2012 thriller film *Pokłosie* (Aftermath), written and directed by Władysław Pasikowski, further awakened Poles to the presence of ghosts in their collective closest. The fictional Gurówka was clearly modeled on Jedwabne. In the film, a Pole who settled in Chicago for many years returns to Poland in 2012. He discovers that his eccentric brother has become a local pariah because of his seemingly inexplicable obsession with Jewish tombstones once used by the Germans to pave a road, now aban-

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